The Ten Commandments — Three-Way Comparison

> **Purpose**: A direct comparison of the Ten Commandments as given in Scripture (Exodus 20 & Deuteronomy 5), against the Roman Catholic Catechism version, and the Modern Protestant position — documenting where each tradition stands and what has been changed, removed, or reinterpreted.

Full Commandment Comparison Table

#	Biblical (Exodus 20 & Deut. 5)	Roman Catholic Catechism	Modern Protestant (Majority)
1	"You shall have no other gods before Me." *(Exodus 20:3)*	"I am the LORD your God. You shall not have strange gods before Me."	"You shall have no other gods before Me." *(Same as Bible — retained)*
2	"You shall not make for yourself a carved image, or any likeness of anything that is in heaven above, or that is in the earth beneath, or that is in the water under the earth. You shall not bow down to them or serve them." *(Exodus 20:4–6)*	⚠ **REMOVED / MERGED** — Absorbed into the 1st Commandment. No longer listed as a separate commandment in the official Catechism.	"You shall not make for yourself an idol." *(Retained as a separate commandment — same as Bible)*
3	"You shall not take the name of the LORD your God in vain." *(Exodus 20:7)*	"You shall not take the name of the LORD your God in vain." *(Renumbered to 2nd)*	"You shall not take the name of the LORD your God in vain." *(Same as Bible)*
4	"**Remember the Sabbath day, to keep it holy. Six days you shall labor and do all your work, but the seventh day is the Sabbath of the LORD your God… For in six days the LORD made the heavens and the earth… and rested the seventh day. Therefore the LORD blessed the Sabbath day and hallowed it.**" *(Exodus 20:8–11)*	⚠ **ALTERED** — "Remember to keep holy the **Lord's Day**." Reworded to refer to **Sunday** (the first day). All reference to "the seventh day" and "the Sabbath" has been removed. *(Renumbered to 3rd)*	⚠ **REINTERPRETED IN PRACTICE** — Text often retained as "Remember the Sabbath day," but the *Westminster Shorter Catechism* redefines fulfillment as **"the first day of the week"** (Sunday/Lord's Day). In practice the vast majority of Protestant churches observe **Sunday**, not the biblical seventh day (Saturday).
5	"Honor your father and your mother, that your days may be long upon the land which the LORD your God is giving you." *(Exodus 20:12)*	"Honor your father and your mother." *(Renumbered to 4th)*	"Honor your father and your mother." *(Same as Bible)*

#	Biblical (Exodus 20 & Deut. 5)	Roman Catholic Catechism	Modern Protestant (Majority)
6	"You shall not murder." *(Exodus 20:13)*	"You shall not kill." *(Renumbered to 5th)*	"You shall not murder." *(Same as Bible)*
7	"You shall not commit adultery." *(Exodus 20:14)*	"You shall not commit adultery." *(Renumbered to 6th)*	"You shall not commit adultery." *(Same as Bible)*
8	"You shall not steal." *(Exodus 20:15)*	"You shall not steal." *(Renumbered to 7th)*	"You shall not steal." *(Same as Bible)*
9	"You shall not bear false witness against your neighbor." *(Exodus 20:16)*	"You shall not bear false witness against your neighbor." *(Renumbered to 8th)*	"You shall not bear false witness." *(Same as Bible)*
10	"You shall not covet your neighbor's house; you shall not covet your neighbor's wife, or his male servant, or his female servant, or his ox, or his donkey, or **anything that is your neighbor's**." *(Exodus 20:17 — one commandment)*	⚠ **SPLIT INTO TWO** — 9th: "You shall not covet your neighbor's **wife**." 10th: "You shall not covet your neighbor's **goods**." This split compensates for the removal of the 2nd Commandment to keep the total count at ten.	"You shall not covet." *(Retained as one commandment — same as Bible)*

Summary of Changes

What Changed	Catholic	Modern Protestant
2nd Commandment (Graven Images)	❌ Removed — merged into 1st	☑ Retained
4th Commandment (Sabbath Day)	❌ Altered — changed to "Lord's Day" (Sunday); all reference to seventh day removed	⚠ Text sometimes kept, but **practice changed to Sunday** by tradition and catechism reinterpretation
10th Commandment (Coveting)	❌ Split into two separate commandments	☑ Retained as one
Total Count	Maintained at 10 by splitting the 10th	Maintained at 10
Authority for Changes	Church Tradition / Papal Authority	Protestant Reformers adopted Sunday from Rome; no explicit biblical mandate given

The Key Alteration — The Sabbath Commandment in Full

Bible (Exodus 20:8–11 — KJV):

> *"Remember the sabbath day, to keep it holy. Six days shalt thou labour, and do all thy work: But the **seventh day** is the sabbath of the LORD thy God: in it thou shalt not do any work, thou, nor thy son, nor thy daughter, thy manservant, nor thy maidservant, nor thy cattle, nor thy stranger that is within thy gates: For in six days the LORD made heaven and earth, the sea, and all that in them is, and rested the seventh day: wherefore the LORD blessed the sabbath day, and hallowed it."*

Catholic Catechism (Catechism of the Catholic Church, 3rd Commandment):

> *"Remember to keep holy the Lord's Day."*

Protestant (Westminster Shorter Catechism, Q59 — Presbyterian/Reformed):

> *"God appointeth one day in seven to be kept holy unto him, which, from the beginning of the world to the resurrection of Christ, was the last day of the week; and, from the resurrection of Christ, was changed into the first day of the week, which in Scripture is called the Lord's day, and is to be continued to the end of the world, as the Christian Sabbath."*

> **Note:** The Bible contains no record of God, Christ, or the Apostles commanding or authorizing this change. The Resurrection occurred on the first day, but no commandment to thereafter worship on that day is recorded in Scripture.

The Removal of the 2nd Commandment — What Was Taken Out

Bible (Exodus 20:4–6 — KJV):

> *"Thou shalt not make unto thee any graven image, or any likeness of any thing that is in heaven above, or that is in the earth beneath, or that is in the water under the earth. Thou shalt not bow down thyself to them, nor serve them: for I the LORD thy God am a jealous God, visiting the iniquity of the fathers upon the children unto the third and fourth generation of them that hate me; And shewing mercy unto thousands of them that love me, and keep my commandments."*

Catholic Catechism: This commandment does not appear as a numbered commandment. It is subsumed under the 1st Commandment.

Protestant: This commandment is retained but is often softened in practice. Many Protestant churches permit religious imagery while forbidding worship of it.

Notable Admissions

Cardinal Gibbons, Archbishop of Baltimore (Letter, 1877–1921 tenure):

> *"Is Saturday the seventh day according to the Bible and the Ten Commandments? I answer yes. Is Sunday the first day of the week and did the Church change the seventh day—Saturday—for Sunday, the first day? I answer yes. Did Christ change the day? **I answer no!**"*

The Convert's Catechism of Catholic Doctrine (Rev. Peter Geiermann, C.Ss.R.):

> *"Q: Why do we observe Sunday instead of Saturday? A: We observe Sunday instead of Saturday because **the Catholic Church transferred the solemnity of Saturday to Sunday**."*

The Catholic Record (London, Ontario — September 1, 1923):

> *"Sunday is our MARK of authority... The church is above the Bible and this transference of Sabbath observance is proof of that fact."*

Protestant Admission — Anglican, Canon Eyton, *The Ten Commandments*, pp. 52, 63, 65:

> Acknowledged that the Fourth Commandment specifies the seventh day (Saturday) and that the change to Sunday came from church tradition, not Scripture.

Protestant Admission — Dr. R.W. Dale, *The Ten Commandments* (New York: Eaton & Mains, pp. 127–129):

> Acknowledged the Sabbath commandment specifies the seventh day; Christian observance of the first day came from tradition.

Protestant Admission — D.L. Moody:

> *"The Sabbath was binding in Eden, and it has been in force ever since... How can men claim that this one commandment has been done away with when they will admit that the other nine are still binding?"*

God's Own Warning Against Changing His Law

> *"You shall not add to the word which I command you, nor take from it, that you may keep the commandments of the LORD your God which I command you."* **(Deuteronomy 4:2)**

> *"Every word of God is pure... Do not add to His words, lest He rebuke you, and you be found a liar."* **(Proverbs 30:5–6)**

> *"For assuredly, I say to you, till heaven and earth pass away, one jot or one tittle will by no means pass from the law till all is fulfilled."* **(Matthew 5:18)**

> *"If anyone adds to these things, God will add to him the plagues that are written in this book; and if anyone takes away from the words of the book of this prophecy, God shall take away his part from the Book of Life."* **(Revelation 22:18–19)**

Sources & References

The Bible (Primary Source)

- **Exodus 20:1–17** — The Ten Commandments as God spoke them
  - Online: https://www.biblegateway.com/passage/?search=Exodus+20&version=NKJV
- **Deuteronomy 5:1–21** — Moses repeats the Ten Commandments
  - Online: https://www.biblegateway.com/passage/?search=Deuteronomy+5&version=NKJV

Catholic Sources

- **Catechism of the Catholic Church (Official — Vatican)** — Ten Commandments listing (with 2nd removed and 10th split):
  - Online Index: https://www.vatican.va/archive/ENG0015/_INDEX.HTM
  - Ten Commandments Section: https://www.vatican.va/archive/ENG0015/__P7D.HTM
  - 3rd Commandment (Sunday/"Lord's Day"): https://www.vatican.va/archive/ENG0015/__P8B.HTM
- **The Convert's Catechism of Catholic Doctrine** — Rev. Peter Geiermann, C.Ss.R.:
  - Catholic apologetics libraries and archives; also quoted extensively in Sabbatarian literature
- **Dies Domini (Apostolic Letter on the Lord's Day)** — Pope John Paul II, 1998:
  - Online: https://www.vatican.va/content/john-paul-ii/en/apost_letters/1998/documents/hf_jp-ii_apl_05071998_dies-domini.html
- **The Catholic Record** — September 1, 1923 (London, Ontario, Canada):
  - Historical newspaper archive; referenced in Sabbatarian literature; consult original issue to verify

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Protestant Sources

- **Westminster Shorter Catechism** (Q57–62 — Sabbath/Lord's Day) — Presbyterian/Reformed:
  - Online: https://www.westminsterconfession.org/resources/confessions/the-westminster-shorter-catechism/
- **Heidelberg Catechism** (Q103 — Lord's Day) — Reformed/Dutch:
  - Online: https://www.heidelberg-catechism.com/en/lords-days/38.html
- **Lutheran Small Catechism** — Martin Luther:
  - Note: Luther followed the Catholic/Augustinian numbering (merging 1st & 2nd commandments, splitting the 10th)
  - Online: https://www.lcms.org/about/beliefs/lutheran-confessions/small-catechism
- **Canon Eyton, *The Ten Commandments***, pp. 52, 63, 65 — Anglican theological libraries
- **Dr. R.W. Dale, *The Ten Commandments***, Eaton & Mains, pp. 127–129 — Used book dealers and theological libraries
- **Dr. Edward T. Hiscox, *The Baptist Manual*** — Baptist historical societies
- **John Wesley, Sermon 25 ("The Law Established through Faith")** — Works of John Wesley:
  - Online: https://www.ccel.org/ccel/wesley/sermons.html

Internal Study Documents (This Series)

- Babylons_Wine_The_Hidden_Legacy_and_Gods_Final_Call.md — Section: "The Ten Commandments: Biblical vs. Catholic"

- Source_Documents_Catholic_Protestant_Admissions.md — Full catalogue of 39 Catholic and 18 Protestant admissions
- Quotes regarding sabbath change catholic and protestant.md — Direct quotes from both traditions
- Study guides/The_Mark_of_the_Beast_Complete_Study_Guide.md — Part 18: The Convert's Catechism
- Study guides/The_Little_Horn_Complete_Study_Guide.md — Daniel 7:25 and the change of law
- Study guides/Daniel_7 & 8_The_Kingdoms_Revealed_Study_Guide.md — Visual chart: 10 Commandments Bible vs. Catholic
- Study guides/ten_commandments_twice_removed.txt — Full text: *Ten Commandments Twice Removed* (Danny Shelton & Shelley Quinn)